

Contents

1	Introduction	3
1.1	Motivation	3
1.2	Main challenges	4
2	Literature review and Project Contribution	6
2.1	Multi-rotor cooperative transportation	6
2.2	Fixed wings cooperative transportation	7
3	System Modelling and Problem formulation	9
3.1	System Model	9
3.2	Classical Control Stack (CCS)	12
3.2.1	Load tracking	12
3.2.2	Carrier Trajectory / Internal Force Calculation: Optimization layer . . .	13
3.3	Learning-based methods	15
4	Methodology	17
4.1	General discussion on the decentralization of the controller	17
4.2	Implementation details	18
4.3	Phase One : Imitation Learning	19
4.3.1	State/Input Design	20
4.3.2	Dataset Aggregation (DAgger)	23
4.3.3	Generalization	30
4.4	Phase Two : Reinforcement Learning	30
4.4.1	Introduction	30
4.4.2	Action Space	32
4.4.3	Observation Space	32
4.4.4	Reward function	37
4.4.5	Centralized Controller Policy Guidance experiment (using Supervised Learning)	41
4.4.6	MAPPO implementation details	41
5	Results and Discussion	44
5.1	Phase One : Imitation Learning	44
5.1.1	Single trajectory	44
5.1.1.1	Supervised Learning	44

5.1.1.2	Dagger	44
5.1.2	Analysis of failure modes	44
5.1.3	Generalization	44
5.1.3.1	Generalization across time	44
5.1.3.2	Generalization across distances	44
5.1.3.3	Generalization across directions	44
5.2	Phase Two : Reinforcement Learning	44
5.2.1	Single trajectory	44
5.2.2	Analysis of failure modes	44
5.2.3	Generalization	44
5.2.3.1	Generalization across time	44
5.2.3.2	Generalization across distances	44
5.2.3.3	Generalization across directions	44
5.2.3.4	History-Augmented Observation Space	44
5.2.3.5	Centralized Controller Policy Guidance experiment (using Supervised Learning)	44
5.2.3.6	Behavior Cloning (BC) of multiple policies	44
6	Conclusion and Future Work	45
	References	46